

Honest to God

What does it look like to authentically follow Jesus? A lot of what has been portrayed about Christianity is a prettied up or photoshopped version of what it truly is like to follow God. In reality, it's messy, it's hard, and it's difficult to follow Jesus, but why is that part of Christianity not talked about more? Maybe we do say it but we don't portray it. A lot of the time in the Christian Bubble, we don't share about our struggles until it is already the good part, but how often do we share our stories in the middle of the struggle?

I feel that God is calling Men's Ministry and CCF to be a community rooted in honest testimony and prayer—a ministry that fully embraces the power of prayer as Jesus intended. In Matthew 7, Jesus tells us that if we ask, it will be given; if we seek, we will find; and if we knock, the door will be opened. This means that when an entire ministry earnestly seeks revival, God promises that if we pursue Him with our whole heart, we will find Him—and He will work through us (Jeremiah 29:13). And if Men's Ministry is firmly rooted in interceding for one another, discerning God's will together, and openly sharing both our joys and struggles, the Spirit will move to transform each of our hearts. When the Holy Spirit is truly present among us, transformation becomes inevitable—we won't have to strive to create revival or force change. If we earnestly seek His presence as a ministry, revival will come naturally, as God works in and through us.

I feel that prayer and honesty are lacking in CCF, particularly among the men. The Bible speaks of the power of collective prayer, yet it often feels like prayer is done casually, without true earnestness. Likewise, there seems to be a barrier preventing us from openly sharing our disappointments, hurts, and struggles with one another. Through testimony-sharing nights, where men can gather to pray over those who are willing to be vulnerable, I hope to invite the Spirit to foster a ministry of openness. My vision is for both leaders and members to share honestly about their relationships with God—through this environment, I pray that the Spirit moves naturally, stirring in us a love for holiness and a desire to pursue righteousness.